PRIMARY FIVE ENGLISH GRAMMAR

Term One | Week 6 | Lesson 4

WHILE AND WHEN

Learning objectives

- Explain the meaning of while and when.

- Recognise and use the correct sentence patterns.

- Write clear and correct sentences in this lesson.

Meaning

While and when connect events in the past. They can help us show actions happening together or interruptions.

Important rules

- While often introduces an action that was continuing in the past.

- When often introduces a shorter event that interrupted a continuing action.

- Two long actions may happen at the same time: While Asha was reading, Musa was writing.

Examples

1. While I was reading, the bell rang.

2. Amina was cooking when the visitors arrived.

3. While the boys were playing, the girls were singing.

4. The lights went off when we were studying.

5. While the teacher was speaking, we were listening.

6. When it started raining, we ran inside.

Worked example

Question: Join: I was walking home. It started raining. (when)

Answer: I was walking home when it started raining.

Common mistakes

Incorrect	Correct
While the bell rang, I was writing.	When the bell rang, I was writing.
I was sleep when the rain began.	I was sleeping when the rain began.
While she reading, he was writing.	While she was reading, he was writing.
They was playing when it rained.	They were playing when it rained.

PRACTICE EXERCISES

A. Complete the sentences or expressions.

1. I was eating ___ the phone rang.

_____

2. ___ Asha was reading, Musa was writing.

_____

3. The bell rang ___ we were singing.

_____

4. ___ the teacher was explaining, we listened.

_____

5. We were playing ___ it began to rain.

_____

6. ___ the baby was sleeping, Mother was cooking.

_____

B. Rewrite or correct as instructed.

7. Join: I was walking home. It started raining. (when)

_____

_____

8. Join: Asha was writing. Musa was reading. (while)

_____

_____

9. Correct: She was cook when I arrived.

_____

_____

10. Correct: While we played, the lights went off. (continuing action)

_____

_____

C. Find and correct the mistakes.

11. While the bell rang, I was writing.

_____

12. I was sleep when the rain began.

_____

13. While she reading, he was writing.

_____

14. They was playing when it rained.

_____

D. Read and answer.

15. State one important rule from this lesson.

_____

_____

16. Write one correct example related to this lesson.

_____

_____

17. Explain the meaning of the grammar form studied.

_____

_____

E. Write your own sentences.

18. Write one clear sentence using the grammar studied in this lesson.

_____

_____

19. Write one clear sentence using the grammar studied in this lesson.

_____

_____

20. Write one clear sentence using the grammar studied in this lesson.

_____

Remember

- While often introduces an action that was continuing in the past.

- When often introduces a shorter event that interrupted a continuing action.

- Two long actions may happen at the same time: While Asha was reading, Musa was writing.